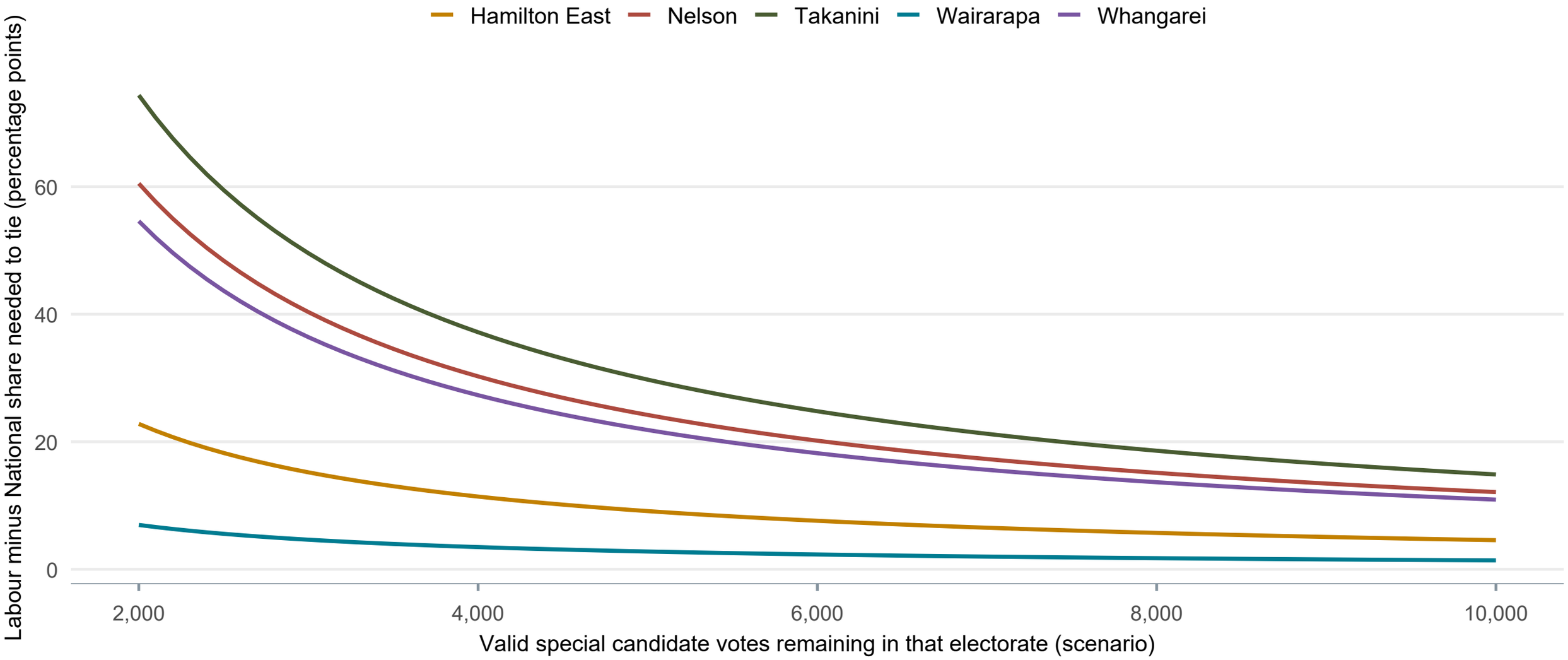
How close National contests depend on special-vote volume

A larger pool of specials needs a smaller Labour lead to erase the same preliminary margin



Source: Electoral Commission preliminary candidate margins; own break-even calculation: 100 x margin / valid specials.
Each curve uses a range of possible volumes, not an official local count or a probability forecast.
Votes for other candidates do not transfer to Labour or National in NZ electorate voting.
Snapshot: 12 November 2026. Calculations and exact plotted data accompany this chart.